



Social Resilience Against Islamophobia

STUDY GUIDE



**THE FIRST FATIH MODEL OIC HIGH SCHOOL
ISTANBUL SUMMIT 2026
SOCIAL RESILIENCE AGAINST ISLAMOPHOBIA
COMMITTEE(SRIC) STUDY GUIDE**

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Welcoming Letter

Dear Delegates,

It is both a pleasure and a great honor to welcome you to the first Fatih Model OIC High School Istanbul Summit 2026. On behalf of the entire Fatih MOIC team, I would like to express our sincere gratitude and happiness to have you join us in this program. Your presence is what makes this summit meaningful, and we are truly excited to bring together such a diverse and motivated group of participants.

At Fatih MOIC, this platform is created for you. Our goal is to support Muslim youth in developing valuable life skills, including critical thinking, diplomacy, and effective communication. Through this program, we hope to reach and connect young individuals from all backgrounds, creating a space where ideas can be shared and perspectives can grow.

We encourage you to actively participate in your committees with respect, openness, and a willingness to collaborate. Engage in discussions, listen to different viewpoints, and make the most of this opportunity. We are confident that, together, we will make this summit a successful and memorable experience for everyone involved.

Yours sincerely,

Adama Serrageh Bah

Secretary General.

Introduction to the Committee

The Social Resilience Against Islamophobia Committee (SRIC) is dedicated to addressing the challenges and discrimination faced by Muslim communities worldwide. It provides a platform for delegates to engage in meaningful discussions on one of the most pressing global issues-Islamophobia.

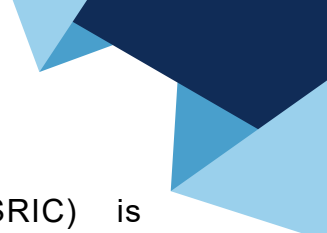
Over the years, Islamophobia has remained a persistent and growing concern, particularly in regions where Muslims are a minority. Its impact continues to affect the social, cultural, and political lives of individuals and communities across the world.

Within this committee, delegates are expected to critically examine the root causes and consequences of Islamophobia, while working collaboratively to develop practical and implementable solutions. Through dialogue, cooperation, and diverse perspectives, SRIC aims to promote understanding and contribute to building more inclusive and resilient societies.

Introduction of the Agenda Item

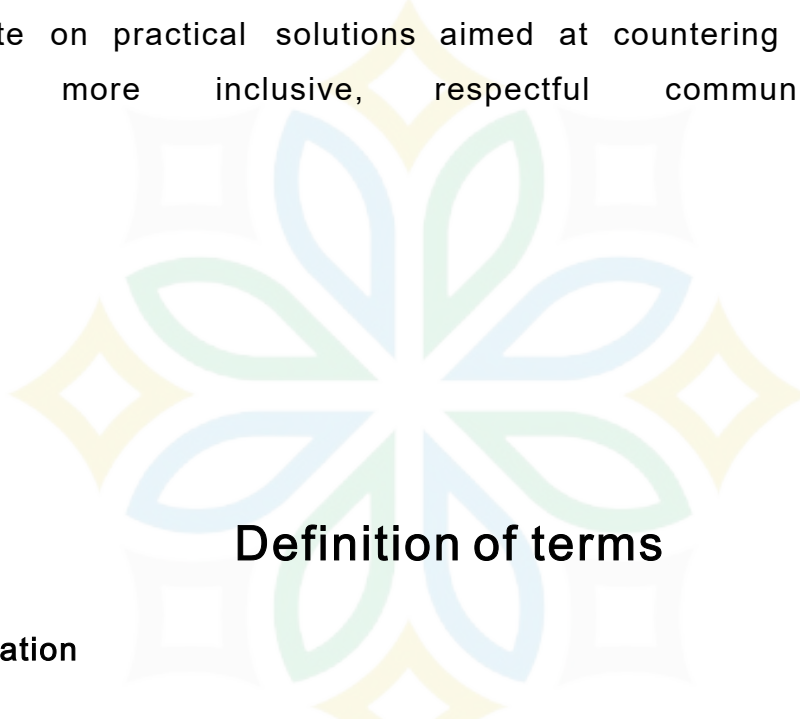
Committee: *Social Resilience Against Islamophobia Committee*

Agenda Item: *“Strengthening Social Resilience to Combat Islamophobia and Protect Muslim Communities”*



The Social Resilience Against Islamophobia Committee (SRIC) is dedicated to addressing the challenges and issues faced by Muslim communities around the world. Within this committee, delegates will engage with the agenda item, “Strengthening Social Resilience to Combat Islamophobia and Protect Muslim Communities,” exploring the realities experienced by Muslims in different regions and societies.

Throughout the conference, delegates are encouraged to actively participate in meaningful discussions, share diverse perspectives, and collaborate on practical solutions aimed at countering Islamophobia and fostering more inclusive, respectful communities worldwide



Definition of terms

Discrimination

Unjust treatment or distinction against individuals or groups based on religion, ethnicity, race, gender, or identity, denying them equal rights and opportunities.

Islamophobia

Prejudice, hostility, or discrimination directed at Islam or Muslims, expressed through stereotypes, exclusion, or violence, undermining religious freedom and dignity.





Hate Speech

Any communication that incites hostility, discrimination, or violence against individuals or groups based on religion, ethnicity, race, or identity.

Resilience

The capacity of individuals and communities to withstand, adapt to, and recover from challenges, rooted in patience and trust in God.

Social Cohesion

The unity and solidarity of society where diverse groups cooperate peacefully, ensuring justice, mutual respect, and collective well-being.

Minority Rights

The rights of religious, ethnic, or linguistic minorities to freely practice their faith, culture, and language, with protection from discrimination and assurance of equal participation.



Background of Islamophobia

Islamophobia is a longstanding global issue shaped by historical political, cultural, and social forces. Its roots trace back to the Middle Ages, particularly the Crusades, when negative portrayals of Muslims were used to justify conflict. These narratives persisted into the colonial era, where they supported European domination over Muslim-majority regions. Edward Said later analyzed this pattern through the concept of Orientalism, explaining how distorted representations of non-Western societies were constructed to maintain power.

In the modern period, Islamophobia became more structured following events such as the Iranian Revolution and the September 11 attacks. These events reshaped media and political discourse, frequently associating Islam with extremism and security threats. This contributed to organized anti-Muslim rhetoric, often reinforced by policies and debates on security and immigration.

Today, Islamophobia operates at systemic levels within global politics and society. It is reflected in state policies, media narratives, and public attitudes, making it a persistent factor influencing international relations and the daily lives of Muslim communities.

Current situation of Islamophobia

Islamophobia is a global issue expressed through hate speech, discrimination, violence, and institutional exclusion. Data across regions shows both its scale and its evolution.

1. Rising Hate Speech and Political Contexts (India)

A 2026 report by India Hate Lab recorded 1,318 hate speech cases in 2025, a 13% increase from 2024 and nearly double the 2023 figure of 668.

Of these, 1,164 incidents occurred in areas governed by the Bharatiya Janata Party or its allies. The highest monthly total was in April 2025 (158 cases), linked to periods of political and security tension.

2. Institutional Discrimination and Religious Oppression (China)

Islamophobia also appears through state policy. The United States Commission on International Religious Freedom 2026 report documents systematic violations against Uyghur Muslims, including mass detention, surveillance, and forced deportations. It also identifies coordinated disinformation efforts denying these abuses.

The situation in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region is widely considered one of the most severe cases of contemporary religious persecution, prompting calls for stronger international action.

3. Increasing Hate Crimes and Social Hostility (United Kingdom)

In the United Kingdom, Islamophobia intensified after 2024 unrest linked to misinformation about the Southport attack. This resulted in riots and targeted attacks on Muslim communities and mosques. By March 2025, 4,478 anti-Muslim hate crimes were recorded, with Muslims accounting for 44–45% of religious hate crime victims, a

19% annual increase.

Surveys show 92% of Muslims feel unsafe in public spaces, and over half report increased stress, especially online.

These findings, based on United Nations definitions of hate speech, are contested by Indian authorities, highlighting disputes over methodology and accountability.

4. Online Hate and Dehumanization

Digital platforms have accelerated Islamophobia through widespread use of dehumanizing language targeting Muslims. Such rhetoric increases the risk of normalization of discrimination and can precede large-scale violence, making online spaces central to the spread of Islamophobic narratives.

Causes of Islamophobia

In Europe, Islamophobia is driven by perceptions of demographic change and cultural threat, reinforced by political narratives framing Islam as a security or identity issue.

Media coverage and public debates on integration amplify these perceptions, while events such as the September 11 attacks continue to influence attitudes. Research, including studies from Spain, shows that political and media discourse has a stronger impact on anti-Muslim sentiment than demographic variables. Resistance to multiculturalism and opposition to religious accommodation sustain these trends.

Globally, Islamophobia includes hate speech, harassment, employment and education discrimination, attacks on religious sites, and policy-level exclusion. Data from 2024 shows it occurs in both Muslim minority and



majority contexts. Key drivers include political tensions, immigration debates, economic insecurity, security concerns, and international crises, all reinforced by media framing and political rhetoric.

Effects of Islamophobia

Islamophobia produces measurable negative health outcomes. At the individual level, it increases stress and encourages identity concealment. At the social level, it weakens community ties. At the structural level, it operates through discriminatory policies and media narratives, contributing to health disparities.

Research using California birth data shows increased adverse birth outcomes among women with Arabic names after the September 11 attacks, indicating direct links between political climate and biological health risks.

Data from 2018 shows women account for 58% of reported anti-Muslim hate incidents, confirming that Islamophobia disproportionately targets women and often overlaps with gender-based harassment.



Actions taken so far

1. International Cooperation

Cooperation between the United Nations and the Organization of Islamic Cooperation has shifted toward structural responses addressing causes of Islamophobia. The 2026 International Day to Combat Islamophobia focused on regulating digital platforms and political rhetoric. Current efforts emphasize implementing human rights standards that classify religious hatred as a governance issue.

2. European Regional Strategy

The European Union Anti-Racism Strategy (2026–2030) integrates anti-Islamophobia measures across policy areas. A 2026 initiative with UNESCO introduces education reforms. The European Commission is also developing a standardized definition of anti-Muslim hatred to improve enforcement and data collection.

3. National Policy: Norway

Norway's Action Plan against Racism and Discrimination (2024–2027) coordinates multiple ministries to address Islamophobia. Measures include police “receipt scheme” to reduce profiling and youth forums targeting anti-Muslim hostility. Municipal funding ensures implementation across local institutions.

4. Targeted Advocacy: Canada

Canada established the Office of the Special Representative on Combating Islamophobia, led by Amira Elghawaby. Its 2025 guide categorizes Islamophobia into systemic, community, and individual levels. The office continues to document intersectional risks, especially for Muslim women, and economic barriers, informing policy and advocacy.

Challenges and gaps for Muslim communities

Discrimination

Muslims face systemic barriers in employment, education, and public services. Studies show lower hiring rates for applicants with Muslim identifiers. In schools, students face bullying and limited cultural inclusion. In public spaces, individuals experience surveillance, harassment, and service denial, restricting equal participation.

Economic Disadvantage

Muslims experience consistent labor market discrimination. A study in France shows Muslim applicants are 2.5 times less likely to receive interview calls than Christian applicants. This contributes to higher unemployment and wage gaps. Muslim-owned businesses also face boycotts and vandalism, limiting economic stability and long-term growth.

Restrictions on Religious Practices

According to the Pew Research Center, Muslims face harassment in over 140 countries. Restrictions include bans on religious attire, limits on mosque construction, and state repression. In regions such as the Sahel and South Asia, legal discrimination combines with mob violence, leaving communities with limited protection.

Possible solutions

1. Recognition and Awareness

Islamophobia must be formally recognized as a threat to rights and social stability. The International Day to Combat Islamophobia provides a global platform for awareness, policy engagement, and coordinated action.

2. National-Level Measures

Governments should integrate Islamophobia into education systems, support youth engagement, and establish research institutions. Security measures must protect vulnerable communities. The Institute for Social Policy and Understanding provides actionable frameworks for education, advocacy, and media accountability.

3. International-Level Measures

States should promote accurate representations of Islam, support diaspora communities, and expand interfaith dialogue. The OIC Islamophobia Observatory monitors global trends and provides policy recommendations to coordinate international responses.

4. Media and Communication

Media institutions and digital platforms must enforce accountability for hate speech while promoting accurate representation. Expanding monitoring systems is necessary to track and counter online Islamophobia.

5. Legal and Institutional Frameworks

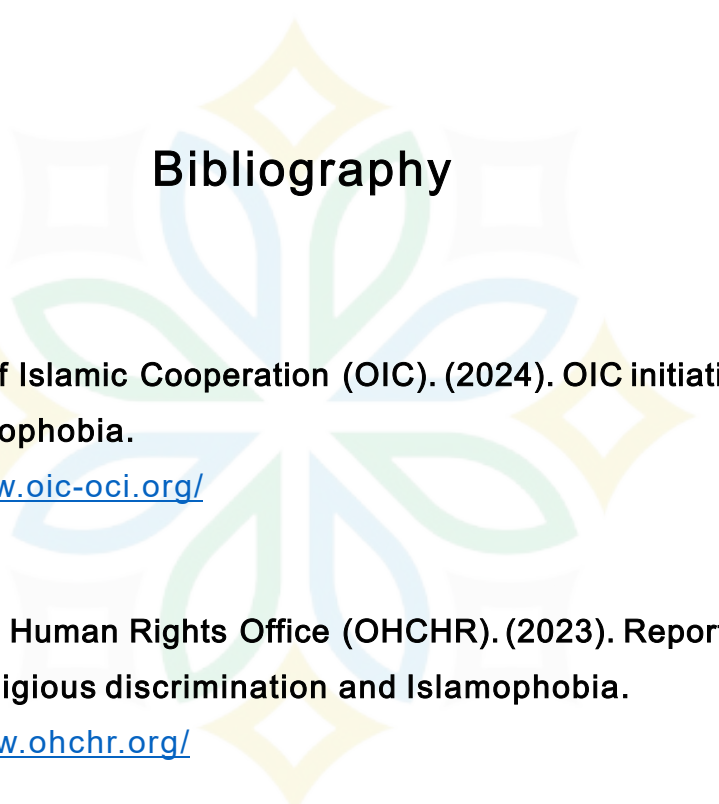
States should implement UN Resolution 16/18 and strengthen compliance through the Istanbul Process. Establishing an OIC Special Envoy would improve coordination with international bodies. Existing mechanisms should be used more effectively for collective action.

6. Leadership and Inspiration

Hussein Ibrahim Taha emphasizes the need to ensure freedom of religion, protect diversity, and eliminate prejudice. This principle should guide all policy and institutional responses.

Guiding Questions

- What practical measures can be taken to develop a standardized framework for national legislation that effectively criminalizes acts of religious desecration while respecting fundamental rights?
- In what ways can the Organization of Islamic Cooperation engage with social media companies to promote transparent reporting mechanisms and fair content moderation regarding anti-Muslim hate speech?
- How can “social resilience” be effectively strengthened among youth to prevent the internalization of harmful stereotypes and promote positive identity formation?
- What strategies can the Organization of Islamic Cooperation implement to address the misuse of national security laws in non-member states that may lead to the unjust securitization of Muslim communities?
- How can educational institutions reform their curricula to both challenge negative stereotypes about Islam and highlight the historical and contemporary contributions of Islamic civilization to global development?
- In what ways can the Organization of Islamic Cooperation collaborate with international organizations to ensure that the principle of freedom of expression is not misused to justify the systematic desecration of sacred religious symbols?



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